Northbank Mental Health Service
Clozapine Clinic
Brisbane, Queensland, Australia

ADVERSE DRUG REACTION REPORT Page 1 of 3

Report date: 11 April 2026
Reporting clinician: Dr Owen Faulkner, Consultant Psychiatrist

PATIENT DETAILS
Initials: D.L.
Age: 54
Sex: Male
Diagnosis: Treatment-resistant schizophrenia

SUSPECT MEDICINE
Clozapine 100 mg tablets. Current dose 300 mg orally once daily at night (titrated from 12.5 mg).
Date started: 9 February 2026
Indication: Treatment-resistant schizophrenia

OTHER MEDICINES
Sodium valproate 500 mg orally twice daily (since 2021).
Lorazepam 1 mg orally at night as required.

CLINICAL NARRATIVE
This 45-year-old gentleman was commenced on clozapine in February 2026 after failing adequate trials of two other antipsychotics. Mandatory haematological monitoring was carried out weekly. White cell count and absolute neutrophil count were within the normal range at each visit until week 8.

At the week 9 visit on 6 April 2026 the absolute neutrophil count was 0.3 x 10^9/L (white cell count 1.8 x 10^9/L). The patient reported a sore throat and fever of 38.6 degrees Celsius for two days. He was admitted to the acute medical unit the same day. Clozapine was ceased immediately. Blood cultures were taken and empirical intravenous piperacillin-tazobactam was started. Filgrastim was commenced on the advice of haematology.

PROGRESS
Neutrophil count on 10 April 2026: 0.9 x 10^9/L and rising. Fever has settled. The patient remains an inpatient and is improving. Clozapine will not be restarted.

SERIOUSNESS
Life-threatening: Yes
Hospitalisation: Yes
Death: No

ASSESSMENT
Agranulocytosis with neutropenic fever, causally related to clozapine (certain). Reported to the national clozapine monitoring registry.

Signed: Dr O. Faulkner